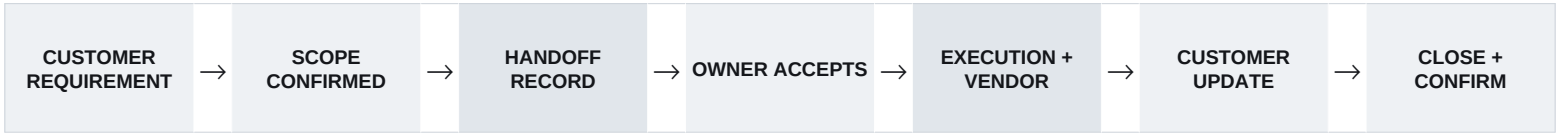
BUSINESS OPERATIONS | PROPOSED CONTROLS

Sales-to-Delivery Handoff Improvement

A practical control design for reducing ambiguity between customer commitment and fulfilment.

01 / THE OPERATING QUESTION

Can every confirmed customer commitment move into delivery with a complete scope, an accountable owner, a due date and a visible exception path?



CONTROL	WHAT IT PREVENTS / CLARIFIES	OWNER / CADENCE
Standard handoff record	Scope, customer preferences, agreed inclusions/exclusions and supporting files travel together.	Sales owner · Every handoff
Named acceptance owner	Delivery confirms acceptance; unresolved fields return as exceptions instead of disappearing in chat.	Delivery owner · At transfer
Commitment + due dates	Each action has one accountable person, target date and status.	Action owner · Ongoing
Exception log	Missing scope, vendor dependency or customer change is visible, prioritised and escalated.	Operations · Daily/weekly review
Customer update cadence	Customer knows next step, owner and expected update timing.	Client owner · At agreed milestones

MEASURE	DEFINITION
Handoff completeness	% records meeting required-field standard
Time to owner acceptance	Elapsed time from transfer to explicit acceptance
Overdue actions	Count and age band of open overdue tasks
Rework / repeated clarification	Frequency of avoidable scope clarification after handoff
On-time closure	% actions or cases closed by agreed date

Implementation sequence: map the current handoff → baseline 3–4 weeks of data → pilot the record and owner acceptance → review exceptions weekly → adjust the controls. Outcomes must be measured after implementation; none are claimed in this sample.